



Braven Career Momentum

Cover note for my Claude Corps application · Vincent Muggli

I made this to answer a real question rather than build a demo: what would a genuinely useful, honest AI project look like for a nonprofit I respect?

Braven prepares college students, most of them first-gen or from low-income backgrounds, for a strong first job after graduation, and its support already runs through six months past graduation. Reading their public materials, one thing stood out. The stretch where Fellows can lose search momentum is also where the signal about whether continued support helps would come from. Help a Fellow keep moving between coaching sessions, and that signal comes out as a byproduct. No separate survey, and what's worth collecting stays Braven's call.

So the concept, Braven Career Momentum, is small on purpose: a short weekly check-in, a next-step plan, a review of a resume or an outreach note, interview prep, and a clear handoff to a person when the moment needs one. It's a support layer, not a replacement for coaches. That line held through every decision I made.

What's in the packet:

- **The deck** (primary): a seven-slide product pitch, designed to sit close to Braven's own editorial style.
- **Working docs**: the scope cut, the experience and escalation design, a constraints-and-risks memo, and a devil's-advocate critique I wrote against my own deck and then used to sharpen it.

The process is the point. I treated Claude as a collaborator with a clear division of labor. It did the research legwork; I judged what was credible. I directed the deck's design and voice instead of accepting a first pass. I ran a discernment step, arguing against the pitch the way a skeptical program lead would, then decided which objections survived and fixed them on the slides. And I kept it honest: every factual claim traces to Braven's public site or its Jobs Report, assumptions are labeled as assumptions, and the open question of what data Braven actually needs is left for Braven to answer.

A few things I was careful about. This is an independent concept, not affiliated with Braven. Nothing has been built or tested. For students who have real reasons to be wary of an institution tracking their search, I made privacy and Fellow control load-bearing rather than a footnote.

The short version of what I'm showing: I can find the spot where a nonprofit's pain point and its mission are the same problem, and design something real and restrained for it. Happy to walk through any of the working docs behind the deck.

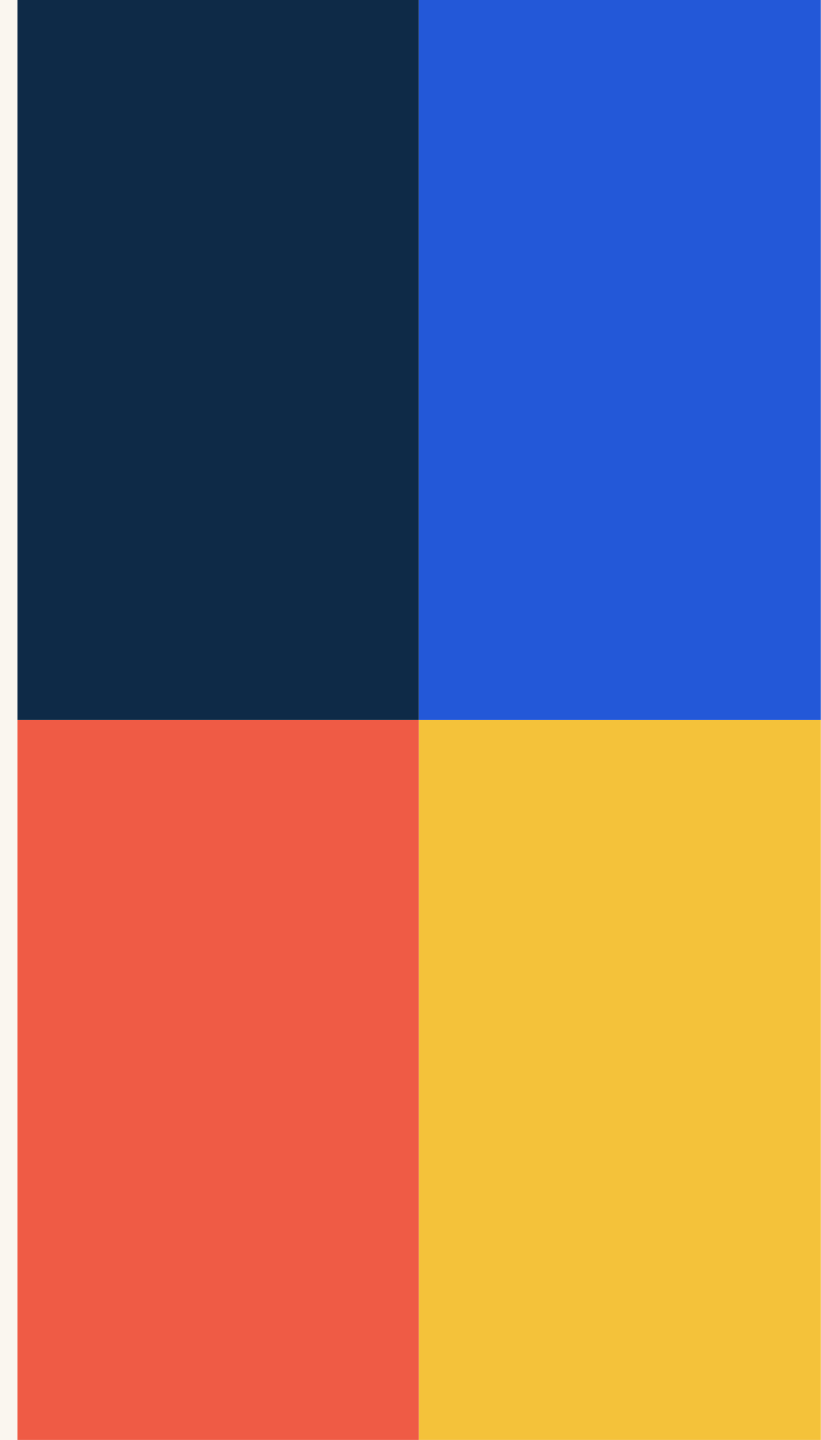
INDEPENDENT PORTFOLIO CONCEPT

Braven Career Momentum

A light support tool for Fellows still working toward a strong first opportunity after the Accelerator.

Braven already backs Fellows with support that runs through six months after graduation. This concept adds a little structure to the weeks between coaching sessions, when a search can quietly stall.

Source: braven.org/enroll



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THE MOMENT AFTER THE COURSE

Between check-ins, a search can go quiet

The Accelerator gives Fellows practice, a cohort, a coach, and a professional portfolio, and Braven's support runs through six months past graduation. Even so, most of the actual searching happens alone, in the gaps: the week after an interview, the third rejection, the application left half-finished in a browser tab.

14–22 pts

How far Braven Fellows sit above their peers in landing a strong role or grad school within six months of graduating.

Braven 2026 Jobs Report



Application fatigue

The tenth application feels heavier than the first, and drafts sit unfinished.



No clear next step

“Apply to more jobs” isn't a plan a Tuesday night can act on.



Follow-through slips

Outreach and thank-you notes fall away when no one is expecting them.



When to ask

Fellows aren't sure a coach's time is worth “just” a resume question.

Braven already provides post-course support. The gap here is rhythm between touchpoints, not a lack of care.

Sources: braven.org, braven.org/enroll, Braven 2026 Jobs Report (jobsreport.braven.org).

A Fellow in the middle of the search

Not a persona with a made-up backstory. A real Braven Fellow or recent alum, mid-search, with a full life around it.

WORKING TOWARD

An internship

A first full-time job

Graduate school

Another strong early-career opening

CARRYING AT THE SAME TIME

- Coursework and, often, a part-time job
- Family responsibilities at home
- A professional network that's still small
- Hiring norms nobody quite explained
- The odd rejection, which stings and stalls a week

A few useful things, and a clear line to people

The tool takes the routine, repeatable asks, so a coach's limited time lands on the moments that need a person.

THE TOOL CAN HELP WITH

- A short weekly check-in
- A next-step plan you can act on this week
- A review of a resume, LinkedIn, cover letter, or outreach note
- Interview preparation
- Follow-through on applications and networking
- Spotting the blockers that keep coming back

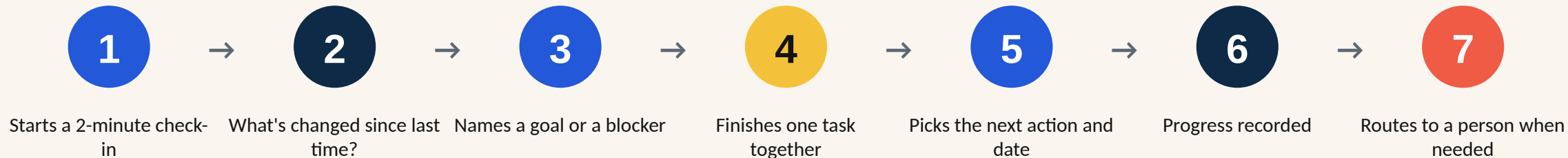
PEOPLE STILL LEAD

- Coaching relationships and the hard conversations
- Judgment on offers, tradeoffs, and career direction
- A warm handoff to a Braven coach, staff member, or alum when the moment calls for a person

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EXAMPLE EXPERIENCE

One check-in, start to finish



Built to stay out of the way. It reads what a Fellow actually wrote and answers what changed this week, then stops. A bolt-on chatbot that feels like a wall can lower engagement (SkillUp / MDRC, 2025); this one is designed against that.

WHAT IT MIGHT SAY

Tool: Last week you wanted to send three outreach notes. How did that go?

Fellow: Sent one.

Tool: One's a start. Want to draft the next two now, or set a time for them?

Learn where support helps. Collect only what's needed.

The same check-ins can show Braven where Fellows get stuck, without a separate survey. Start small, keep it voluntary, and label it plainly.

PROPOSED STARTING SIGNALS • NOT CONFIRMED REQUIREMENTS

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ■ Check-in completion | ■ Current search stage |
| ■ Applications or networking done | ■ Interview-prep activity |
| ■ Self-reported confidence or clarity | ■ Common blockers |
| ■ Requests for a person | ■ Outcomes, when shared voluntarily |

For Fellows: a check-in never affects your standing, and you choose what's shared.

Voluntary outcomes skew optimistic; treat them as directional and lean on Braven's existing outcome tracking for the firmer read.

Signals and question are proposed by this concept for discussion with Braven, not existing Braven practice.

THE OPEN QUESTION

What's the least evidence Braven's program, impact, and development teams need to tell whether continued career support is working?

Define it with Braven's program, impact, development, data, and privacy people. The aim is useful learning, not reporting burden or intrusive collection.

Start small. Test it. Keep a person close.

THE FIRST VERSION

- One guided check-in conversation
- Two or three support workflows
- A simple progress record
- A clear path to a human
- A staff summary from approved data (the gated, hard part)
- A pilot with a small group first

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE WITH BRAVEN

- What Fellows would actually find useful
- Which moments need a person
- What staff should be able to see
- What should never be collected
- Which outcomes matter
- How it fits existing Braven support

The first goal is not to automate the relationship. It's to learn where a small amount of structure could help Fellows keep moving—and where a person should step in.